

Georgetown Orthodox Christian Fellowship

Vespers: Wednesday, August 19, 2026

Memory of the Holy Prophet Samuel

Feel free to read or chant during the service!

Stichera

Tone 1. *If You, O Lord, should mark iniquities, O Lord, who shall stand? For with You there is forgiveness.*

Lady, your Son and God, who from you * became incarnate and for our sake became like us,* when He was well pleased to take you out of the world to himself, * before your translation, summoned and convened * His followers wondrously, who were carried on clouds to you. * And they assembled in your presence to bury you, * O all-holy Virgin, with all honors and dignity. * Seeing you, who are full of grace, they also were filled with grace; * they venerated and kissed you, the blessed Mother, saluting you * and faithfully singing, * “You have borne the great mercy for all the world. Rejoice!”

Because of Your Name have I waited for You, O Lord; my soul has waited upon Your word, my soul has hoped in the Lord. “How did you come to know that the time * for my departure from my body was near at hand? * My children, what is this strange sight?” the Theotokos inquired * of the Lord’s Disciples when they had arrived. * Replying, they said, “You see, we were transported suddenly * on clouds and brought here to your dwelling to venerate * you the allegorical fiery throne of God, * and to behold your glorious translation as you depart, * and with our own hands to bury your holy body that hosted God, * O pure and most blessed * holy Mother, through whom great mercy came to all the world.”

From the morning watch until night, from the morning watch let Israel trust in the Lord. Lady, as you repose on your bed, * the Lord’s Disciples in attendance escorted you * to Lady, as you reposed on your bed, the Lord’s Disciples in attendance escorted you to bury your holy body, as laws of nature require. * Processing, they sang you funerary hymns. * They cried out saluting you, “Blessed palace of God, rejoice! * Ready assistance of humanity all, rejoice! * Purest chariot that conveyed God himself, rejoice! * Go now and be transported to eternal mountains on high. * Glorious dwelling, go dwell now in the divine dwellings evermore, * and pray for the faithful, to be granted great mercy and never-ending peace.”

Tone 4. *For with the Lord there is mercy and with Him is abundant redemption, and He will deliver Israel from all his iniquities.* Your mother received the answer to her prayer, giving birth you * as the fruit of her barren womb; * and she dedicated you, even as she promised, * to her Benefactor and God, to whom she gave you back * as an acceptable gift, O Samuel. * The Spirit’s grace rested on you, glorious Prophet, as you progressed * in all virtue and innocence and advanced in sagacity.

Praise the Lord, all you nations; praise Him, all you peoples. Since you were anointed with the grace of God, being both a priest * and a prophet, O Samuel, * you foresaw what was to come. * And at God’s instruction, * you anointed kings and also foretold coming events * and justly judged the people of Israel, * who constantly transgressed the Law and wandered far from the Lord their God, * holy, God-bearing, all-extolled, * blessed, praiseworthy man of God.

For His mercy is great towards us, and the truth of the Lord endures forever. No longer in shadows and enigmas as you previously * had perceived, but now face to face * you see Him, for whom you longed; * for you have transcended * the dark cloud and weight of the flesh, and now you walk about * on high, experiencing exultant joy. * You live among the Angels, and you are esteemed with the prophets all * and

converse with the righteous saints, * O revered Prophet Samuel.

Tone 2. *Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit. Both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.* At your Dormition that transcended death, O Theotokos and Mother of Life, clouds caught the Apostles up into the air; and, from being dispersed throughout the world, they were reunited before your immaculate body. And when they had buried you with dignity, they lifted up their voices and sang the words of Gabriel, “Rejoice, O unwedded and virgin Mother who are full of grace; the Lord is with you.” Along with them, entreat your Son and our God, for the salvation of our souls. y

Aposticha

Tone 2 O House of Ephratha. Οἶκος τοῦ Ἐφραθᾶ. “W here are you going now, * O Lady,” said the Savior’s * Apostles as they followed * your body that had held God, and sang the hymns of burial.

Arise, O Lord, into Your rest, You and the ark of Your holiness. Come, all we born on earth, * and let us form a choir * and sing burial anthems * and honor the Translation today of the Mother of God.

The Lord swore to David this truth, and He shall not reject it, “I shall set upon your throne one from the fruit of your loins.” Be lifted up, O gates * of heaven when you see her, * the gate of the Most High God, * as she proceeds in glory toward her Son, our Lord and God.

Tone . *Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit. Both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.* Same Melody.

Virgin, the earth was blessed * because your grave was in it. * By your extraordinary * ascent the air was hallowed, * when you succumbed to nature’s laws.

Apolytikion

Tone

Troparion for Mary of Egypt Tone 8 In you the image was preserved with exactness, O Mother; for taking up your cross, you did follow Christ, and by your deeds you did teach us to overlook the flesh, for it passes away, but to attend to the soul since it is immortal. Wherefore, O righteous Mary, your spirit rejoices with the Angels.